Stayman and Jacoby Transfers

The Stayman convention is used to find a 4-4 Major suit fit after one partner has opened 1NT or 2NT. Responder bids an artificial 2♣ and the Notrump bidder then bids a 4-card Major if she has one, or 2 or 3 ♦ otherwise.

The Jacoby Transfer convention is used to uncover a 5-3 Major suit fit after one partner has opened 1NT or 2NT. A response of ♦s asks opener to bid ♥s, a response of ♥s asks opener to bid ♠s.

The two conventions complement each other, that's why they are together in this set of practices.

Board: 1
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 2♠
Declarer: North
Lead: ♥3

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4♥
Declarer: East
Lead: ♦J

Board: 3
Dealer: **South**

Contract: 4♠
Declarer: South
Lead: ♥5

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**

Contract: 4♠
Declarer: West
Lead: ♣K

Board: 5
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♠
Declarer: North
Lead: ♦Q

Board 1
North Deals
None Vul

♠ K J 5
♥ A 7 6
♦ A 8 3
♣ K Q 9 4

♠ A 10
♥ K Q 10 9
♦ J 10 6 2
♣ 10 6 2



♠ 9 4
♥ J 4 3 2
♦ K Q 7
♣ A J 8 7

♠ Q 8 7 6 3 2
♥ 8 5
♦ 9 5 4
♣ 5 3

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1NT	Pass	2♥
Pass	2♠		
All Pass			

2♠ by North
Lead: ♥3

NORTH, with a balanced 17 point hand naturally opens 1NT.

SOUTH has a really awful hand, but she does hold six ♠s. So she uses Jacoby Transfer, and when NORTH bids 2♠ she passes!

Board 2
East Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ J 10 9 8 ♥ 5 3 ♦ K Q 4 2 ♣ 6 5 2	
♠ A K 7 2 ♥ A J 8 6 ♦ 5 3 ♣ 10 8 4		♠ Q 6 3 ♥ Q 10 9 2 ♦ A 7 6 ♣ A K 3
	♠ 5 4 ♥ K 7 4 ♦ J 10 9 8 ♣ Q J 9 7	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1NT	Pass
2♣	Pass	2♥	Pass
4♥			
All Pass			

4♥ by East
Lead: ♦J

WEST has four cards in each Major suit - this is an ideal situation for Stayman.

EAST shows a ♥ suit and WEST immediately bids game in that suit.

Board 3
South Deals
None Vul

	♠ K 9 7 4 ♥ K 8 6 2 ♦ 7 3 ♣ 8 6 5	
♠ J 6 ♥ 10 7 5 ♦ A 8 5 ♣ K 10 7 4 2		♠ 10 5 3 ♥ J 9 4 ♦ Q J 9 4 ♣ J 9 3
	♠ A Q 8 2 ♥ A Q 3 ♦ K 10 6 2 ♣ A Q	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			2NT
Pass	3♣	Pass	3♠
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			

4♠ by South
Lead: ♥5

Stayman convention works just fine after a 2NT opening, just at a higher level.

NORTH knows that 6 points will be enough for game opposite SOUTH's 20-21, she just needs to find out if there is a 4-4 Major suit fit. There is, in ♠s.

Board 4
West Deals
Both Vul

	♠ K 3 ♥ Q 6 5 2 ♦ K 9 4 3 ♣ K Q 7	
♠ A J 10 ♥ K 9 ♦ A 8 7 2 ♣ A 10 9 6	N W E S	♠ Q 9 8 7 4 ♥ A J 10 8 3 ♦ Q 6 ♣ 5
	♠ 6 5 2 ♥ 7 4 ♦ J 10 5 ♣ J 8 4 3 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1NT	Pass	2♥	Pass
2♠	Pass	4♥	Pass
4♠			
All Pass			

4♠ by West
Lead: ♣K

EAST has five cards in each Major and WEST opens 1NT.

First EAST bids 2♥, indicating a 5-card ♠ suit with the Transfer bid. Then, after WEST bids the obligatory 2♠, EAST jumps to 4♥, promising enough strength for game, and also five ♥s to go with the five ♠s.

WEST prefers ♠s, so she corrects the contract to 4♠.

Board 5
North Deals
N-S Vul

♠ A 9 6
♥ K Q 6 2
♦ K 5 3 2
♣ K 8

♠ 3
♥ J 10 5 3
♦ 10 9 7 4
♣ A J 9 3



♠ J 10 8 7
♥ A 9 4
♦ Q J 6
♣ 10 5 2

♠ K Q 5 4 2
♥ 8 7
♦ A 8
♣ Q 7 6 4

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1NT	Pass	2♥
Pass	2♠	Pass	3NT
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			

4♠ by North
Lead: ♦Q

With 12 points and five ♠s, when SOUTH hears her partner open 1NT she knows there is a game - either 3NT or 4♠.

SOUTH first transfers NORTH to ♠s, then jumps to 3NT, giving NORTH the choice.

NORTH has three ♠s, so he chooses 4♠, taking the 8-card Major fit.